

Sandwich Sanctuary Brings Joy and Support to Bright To Special Home

JOHOR BAHRU, 17 June 2026 - A group of students (ULRS 3032 Section 10 Group 2) from Universiti Teknologi Malaysia under the project “Sandwich Sanctuary” successfully organized a charity visit to Bright To Special Home, a social welfare centre in Skudai involving 15 residents.



Figure 1: Group photo of Sandwich Sanctuary Team at Bright To Special Home

The visit featured a series of interactive activities, including drawing and singing sessions, designed to encourage creativity, and social interaction among individuals with Down Syndrome or autism. Participants were given opportunities to express themselves in a supportive environment while fostering stronger connections. They were also intended to promote confidence and active engagement among the residents.



Figure 2: Art activities conducted at Bright To Special Home



Figure 3: Singing sessions at Bright To Special Home

“Social entrepreneurship projects allow students to apply entrepreneurial thinking while creating meaningful value for the community”, said Dr Umar Haiyat Abdul Kohar. It has been observed that the implementation of such projects would not only allow students to think entrepreneurially and learn teamwork, but also create socially conscious individuals.

Furthermore, appreciation is extended to project leader Elijah She Yu Sheng for his exceptional leadership and dedication. He actively coordinated communication with Sharon, the person in charge of Bright To Special Home, ensuring clear discussions on the event details. This commitment contributed to the successful execution of the visit.

“Because of all of you, we were able to spread love beyond ourselves”. The project leader found the experience truly meaningful because the team interacted enthusiastically with the residents. Their warm welcome reminded him that small acts of care can help them feel loved and valued. He was sincerely thankful to the effort put in by every teammate.



Figure 4: Group photo with residents at Bright To Special Home holding up their artwork

Notably, throughout the activities, participants showed increased confidence, creativity, and willingness to engage with others. The experience also encouraged students to develop empathy and a deeper understanding of the needs of disabled individuals.

Executed as a practical social project for their Entrepreneurship and Innovation course (ULRS3032), the initiative focuses on addressing disability welfare by converting business profit to daily necessities donation and companionship. Therefore, a dual social value is created: promoting nutritional health among university students while reducing financial burden of care for individuals with disabilities.



Figure 5: Essential items and daily necessities purchased for Bright To Special Home using funds raised from sandwich sales.

The Sandwich Sanctuary project reflects UTM's commitment to producing well-rounded graduates, aligning directly with SeMy 2030 and the Higher Education Institution (IPT) Entrepreneurship Action Plan. This community engagement provided the students an opportunity to develop empathy, teamwork, and holistic development through experiential learning.

To conclude, the Sandwich Sanctuary project highlights how small actions can create meaningful change in society. Through this initiative, UTM students not only strengthened their entrepreneurial and teamwork skills, but also contributed to improving the well-being of the residents of Bright To Special Home. This experience serves as a reminder that compassion, collaboration, and social responsibility are essential in building a more inclusive and caring society.